independent in 2009 but later joined the Congress. Now he dons those six-shooters for the BJP. On the other, K.P. Vivekanand Goud, the man who's been wearing the TRS/ BRS badge since 2016 and lording it over Quthbullapur since 2014. That's almost a decade as an MLA. Enough time for rivals to make up a long chargesheet of 'unfulfilled promises'. That's all the 57-year-old Kuna was doing to K.P. Now, it's Kuna who has looks that wouldn't be out of place in a *dangal*—gruff, bearded, of robust build. But it was the bespectacled K.P., a 46-year-old with an engineering degree, who charged towards his inquisitor and roughed him up even as the cameras were rolling. Luckily, the anchor and other channel hands intervened even as the first televised dishoom dishoom of Indian democracy could draw blood—though it did go viral on social media. Kuna, in fact, kept his composure through it all. "We share the same surname but are not close relatives," he later said. "He is welcome to file a defamation case against me, but I'm ready to prove my charges with evidence." The BJP has also demanded that K.P. be debarred from the November 30 poll. ■

Y Me?



Expect a lot of whys, and Ys, here. Y.S. Sharmila, sister of Yuvajana Sramika Rythu Congress Party (YSRCP) chief Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy, and founder of YSR Telangana Party (YSRTP), is crying foul. Why? She wants another poll symbol instead of the 'binoculars' given to her party. The Indian voter does not look that far out, she feels. She has asked the Election Commission to allot a symbol that has a more familiar, downhome feel—like a farmer and plough. The binocs, by the way, show a tough passage ahead for her in Khammam's Palair seat. Her rival is the redoubtable Ponguleti Srinivas Reddy, former YSRCP chief in Telangana, close to the YSR family since the days of her dad...well, YSR...and now the Congress candidate. ■



TWICE ROASTED

The BJP in Rajasthan burnt its fingers once, with the first list, and then proceeded to burn them again with the second. The first time sparked dissidence all over, so they tried to make amends the second time. Narpat Singh Rajvi, son-in-law of party icon Bhairon Singh Shekhawat, was 'unceremoniously' denied a ticket from Vidyadhar Nagar despite having won it thrice in a row. So he was given the ticket from Chittorgarh, hometown of state chief C.P. Joshi. But what was a sureshot seat has turned into a snakepit with a strong local revolt. Rajvi could visit his battlefield only after a week. ■



November 25 so as to account for the 50,000 weddings on November 23, MP's November 17 voting is robbing thousands of *baraats* further south of their fizz. The other day, cops in Dhar seized 501 cases of single malt whisky worth Rs 1.5 crore from a truck. The haute hooch was on its way to a South Indian state. Then, a vigilant posse at the MP-UP border seized premium liquor worth Rs 3.5 crore. In both cases, the source of the booze was Gurugram and it was clearly not meant for 'election duty'—however cash-rich politicians get, they are not known to get desperate enough to buy voter affections with single malt! Thing is, Gurugram is perhaps India's cheapest tavern for top-end brands and the price advantage ensures liquor from its stores is supplied all over—even if it violates excise laws. So purity in MP has turned puritanical for others. The 'Gurgaon route' is disrupted, and it's keeping thousands of *baraatis* sober across India. ■

-*By* **Rohit Parihar, Amarnath K. Menon and Rahul Noronha**